

PIONEER 10

Space probe

Launched on 3 March 1972, Pioneer 10's principal mission was to study Jupiter. On its journey to the gas giant, it became the first spacecraft to cross the Asteroid Belt, dispelling doubts about the risk of collisions in this region. After it had flown past Jupiter, the probe continued to provide information on the most distant parts of our Solar System.

By the time of last contact, Pioneer 10 was **12 billion km** (7.5 billion miles) away from Earth.

Antenna relayed data to Earth

Jupiter

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.9 m (9.5 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 3 March 1972



MISSION DURATION: 30 years, 10 months, 22 days (at last contact)



SPACE AGENCY: NASA